

device that measures roughly 6.7x2.9x0.9 inches and weighs just under 300 grams.

The most striking feature, without a doubt, is the large 4.3-inch LCD screen that displays 16 million colours at a resolution of 480x272 pixels.

On the right of the screen are the four standard buttons found on the DualShock and SixAxis – Cross, Square, Triangle and Circle.

On the other side of the screen, users will find a four-way navigational pad for movement as well as an analogue ‘nub’ below it.

Below the screen, a row of buttons provides options such as the PlayStation Home button, increasing and decreasing volume, ‘Select’, ‘Start’, music settings and screen settings.

The corners at the top of the PSP feature two translucent ‘bumper’ buttons, which imitate the functions of the L1 and R1 buttons on the DualShock.

Processor and GPU

The main microprocessor of the PlayStation Portable is a multifunction device named “Allegrex” that runs two 333 MHz R4000-based CPUs. The hardware was originally forced to run more slowly than it was capable and most games ran at 222 MHz. However, with firmware update 3.50 on 31 May 2007, Sony removed this limit and allowed new games to run at a full 333 MHz.

The PSP relies on a tiny graphics processing unit. The whole system has 32 MB main RAM in the original PSP and 64 MB in the PSP 2000 and subsequent series, and 4 MB embedded DRAM in all models. Out of these 4MB of eDRAM, 2MB is dedicated to the GPU and 2MB is further dedicated to the Media Engine secondary processor.

UMD Drive

Just like the PlayStation 3 was the launching point for Sony’s Blu-Ray optical format for 12-cm disks, the PSP was expected to do the same for the company’s proprietary ‘Universal Media Disk’ format for 6.5cm disks.

A single-layer UMD disk can hold around 900 MB of data, while a dual-layer UMD disk can store approximately



The PSP uses a proprietary disc called the UMD, which makes the main console a whole lot thicker than it needs to be